

it how far away from the mouse cursor it should look for an edge. For example, a setting of 10px will make the Magnetic Lasso look for edges that are in a range of 10 pixels around the mouse cursor, while a setting of 50 will make it look in a range of 50 pixels.

The Edge Contrast setting tells the lasso how much contrast there should be between two areas for it to define an edge. A lower setting will cause the selection to form even when the contrast on either side of the edge is low; a higher setting will be more sensitive to contrast and works well for well-defined edges.

The Frequency setting defines how frequently fastening points will be made—a higher setting will cause more points to be created, anchoring the selection quicker.

If you are working with a graphics tablet, the Stylus Pressure button enables the edge width to be adjusted according to the pen pressure that you apply.

3.3 Even More Selection Tools

As we've seen, Photoshop lets you draw your own selections, but there comes a time when you can't be expected to manually make your selections: what if you wanted to select all the blue areas of the image? Luckily, Photoshop's selection abilities don't end there.

3.3.1 The Magic Wand

The Magic Wand tool (Shortcut: [W])  lets you select areas that are of the same (or similar) colour—extremely useful when the lasso tools don't work.

When you click on an area of the image with the Magic Wand, areas of the image that are similar in colour to the area you clicked on become part of the selection. *How* similar is determined by the Tolerance value in the option bar at the top. A